MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PARACHUTE SYSTEM, SPECIAL WEAPONS, A/B28K-5, 23 FT

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the requirements for a special weapons parachute system designated A/B28K-5.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

V-T-295	Thread, Nylon

Military

MIL-P-5610	Parachute Assemblies and Major Sub-assemblies, Packaging and Packing of
MIL-I-6903	Ink, Marking (For Parachutes and Other Textile Items)
MIL-H-7195	Hardware, Parachute, General Specification for

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-595	Colors
FED-STD-751	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

Military

MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-130	Identification Marking of US Military Property
MIL-STD-143	Standards and Specifications, Order of Precedence for the Selection of
MIL-STD-849	Inspection Requirements, Definitions and Classification of Defects for Parachutes
MIL-STD-889	Dissimilar Metals

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DRAWINGS

Air Force

59J6276	Deployment Bag - Guide Surface Parachute
68C212	Parachute System, Special Weapons A/B28K-5, Assembly of
68J215	Deployment Bag, Parachute - Special Weapons
68K213	Canopy - Guide Surface Parachute, 3 Ft Dia, 8 Gore
69J162	Canopy, Parachute - Ribbon, Conical, 23 Ft Dia

PUBLICATION

Air Force Specification Bulletin

530 Verification Testing of Parachute Textile Materials

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Qualification. The parachute systems furnished under this specification shall be products which are qualified for listing on the applicable qualified products list at the time set for opening of bids (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.2 Component parts. The parachute system shall consist of the component parts specified on Drawing 68C212. Drawings 68C212-1, 68C212-2, and 68C212-3 pertain to live, dummy, and training systems, respectively.

3.3 Selection of specifications and standards. Specifications and standards for necessary commodities and services not specified herein shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-143.

3.4 Materials

3.4.1 Fungus-proof materials. Materials that are nutrients for fungi shall not be used where it is practical to avoid them. Where used and not hermetically sealed, they shall be treated with a fungicidal agent acceptable to the procuring activity. However, if they will be used in a hermetically sealed inclosure, fungicidal treatment will not be necessary.

3.4.2 Textile materials. Textile materials which have been manufactured (as evidenced by date of manufacture) more than 2 years prior to the date of award of contract shall not be used in the fabrication of the parachute system component parts. When natural is the color specified for textile materials used in the fabrication of parachute components, all colored marker threads required by applicable

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specifications shall be omitted and replaced with natural-colored threads. All natural-color textile materials shall be free of blemishes and foreign matter. Only natural-color textile materials shall be used in the fabrication of the canopy.

3.4.3 Thread. The thread used for stitching shall conform to type I and II, class 1 of V-T-295. The size of the thread shall be as specified on the drawing or detail specification. The color of the thread shall be natural.

3.4.4 Metals. Metals shall be of the corrosion-resistant type or suitably treated to resist corrosion due to fuels, salt spray, or atmospheric conditions likely to be met in storage or normal service. Unless otherwise specified, all metal hardware shall conform to MIL-H-7195.

3.4.4.1 Dissimilar metals. Unless protected against electrolytic corrosion, dissimilar metals shall not be used in intimate contact with each other. Dissimilar metals are defined in MIL-STD-889.

3.5 Design and construction. The design and construction of the parachute component parts shall conform to applicable drawings.

3.6 Operation. The sequence of operation shall be the firing of a pyrotechnic charge to deploy the pilot chute after release of the load from the carrier. The pilot chute then extracts and deploys the main canopy.

3.7 Canopy. The canopy shall be of the continuous ribbon type. Canopy layout and construction details shall conform to Drawing 69J162.

3.7.1 Drag surface. All material required to manufacture the drag surface for the canopy shall be taken from a minimum practical number of lots of each individual type of material.

3.7.2 Suspension lines. Slotted suspension lines shall be as follows:

a. Slotted suspension lines shall be continuous and without splices for each length specified by the applicable drawing.

b. The suspension line length from the canopy skirt to the attachment loop shall be marked before the drag surface portion of the line is sewn into the radial seam of the canopy.

c. All suspension lines for one canopy shall be marked within an 8-hour period or one work shift.

d. All suspension lines for one canopy shall be taken from the same lot and loom.

3.8 Pilot chute. The pilot chute shall be of the guide surface type. Canopy layout and construction details shall conform to Drawing 68K213.

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3.9 Deployment bag(s). The layout and construction details of the deployment bags shall conform to Drawings 59J6276 and 68J215 for the guide surface and ribbon parachutes, respectively.

3.9.1 Dummy parachute. For the system specified as 68C212-2 the deployment bags shall be used without the canopies.

3.10 Stitching. The stitches shall conform to FED-STD-751. Unless otherwise specified, stitch type 301 shall be used. The size of the thread and the number of stitches per inch applicable to stitch type shall be as specified in table I.

TABLE I. Thread Size and Stitches Per Inch

Letter or No. Size	Stitches per Inch		
	Straight Stitch 1/	Zigzag Stitch	
	Type 301	Single Throw	Double Throw
E	7 to 11 2/	12 to 16	8 to 12
F	7 to 11 2/	12 to 14	7 to 10
FF	6 to 9 2/	12 to 14	7 to 10
3	5 to 8		4 to 6
5	4 to 6		3 to 5
6	4 to 6		3 to 5

1/ Where abrupt changes occur in the thickness of material in excess of 1/32 inch the number of stitches specified in this table may vary plus or minus 2 stitches per inch for a distance not exceeding 3/4 inch.

2/ A maximum of 16 stitches per inch for a length not exceeding 2 inches in any o place with a minimum distance of 12 inches between locations will be acceptab No section or gore shall contain more than 16 stitches per inch.

3.10.1 Tension. The tension of the bobbin and needle threads shall be equal so that the thread lock will lie as close as possible in the center of the layers below the surface. Multiple-needle machines shall be adjusted to provide the same tension from each needle.

3.10.2 Straight stitching. All straight stitching with single-needle machines shall be backstitched for a distance of not less than 1/2 inch. Multiple rows of straight stitching shall be distributed equally across the seam when a single-needle machine is used. When using commercial, multiple-needle machines, the standard gages will be acceptable. For both single-needle and multiple-needle machine stitching, the distance from the edge of the seam or material to the outside row of stitching shall be 1/8 inch, plus or minus 1/16 inch.

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3.10.3 Cross and box stitching. Cross and box stitching shall be straight, neat, and even. To insure good workmanship, outlines may be used as stitching guides. To preclude the possibility of damage to the canopy, outlines or any marking shall be of approved materials.

3.10.4 Zigzag stitching (see 6.5.1). Zigzag stitching shall be as follows:

a. When parallel to straight stitching, zigzag stitching shall normally not overlap the straight stitching.

b. When only one row of zigzag stitching is specified, the stitching shall be centered.

c. Where the material thickness is more than doubled, the width of the zigzag stitching may vary plus or minus 50 percent or the number of stitches may vary plus or minus 2 stitches per inch, beyond that specified in table I, for a distance not exceeding 3/4 inch.

d. The tolerance permitted on the length of each row of zigzag stitching shall be plus 1/2 or minus 0 inch.

3.10.5 Basting stitch. The removal of basting thread will not be necessary provided that nylon thread, size E or lighter, is used.

3.11 Seams. Seams shall conform to FED-STD-751. The seams shall be flat and smooth to preclude pleating, ragged edges, cloth edges not properly caught, and puffiness of fabric between the rows of stitching. In the interest of good workmanship, every effort shall be made to produce a fully folded flat seam which shall contain no excessive puffiness.

3.12 Splicing. Unless otherwise specified, splices of webbings, tapes, and ribbons used in assembling the parachute component parts shall be held to a minimum and shall not exceed the number specified in table II. When two or more layers of the same material are used in a seam, one layer shall be continuous across the splice of the other layer. Unless otherwise specified, the splice shall be made by overlapping the ends for a distance of not less than 4 inches. Unless otherwise specified, vent reinforcement splices shall be across at least two adjacent radial reinforcements. Vent, skirt, and reinforcing band splices shall not appear in the same gore.

3.12.1 Continuous ribbon. All continuous horizontal ribbon construction shall have the splices centered at the radial reinforcement and staggered in a spiral manner around the canopy. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable drawing, the number of splices per continuous ribbon shall be in accordance with table II.

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TABLE II. Frequency of Splices and Repairs

Length of Seam (Inches)	Number of Splices	Number of Repairs
0 to 2	0	0
2 to 12	0	1
12 to 72	0	2
72 to 240	1	3
240 to 360	2	4
360 to 480	3	5
480 to 600	4	6
Over 600	1 per 120 inches	1 per 100 inches

3.13 Repairs (see 6.5.2)

3.13.1 Repair stitching. All stitching defects shall be repaired by either overstitching or adjacent stitching which shall extend a length of 3 inches, plus or minus 1 inch, beyond the ends of the defective stitching. Repair of stitching shall be made with stitch type 301. The frequency of stitching repairs shall be not more than specified in table II.

3.13.1.1 Removal of the original stitching will not be necessary if the following defects occur during the sewing operation:

a. Thread breakage

b. Two consecutive skipped stitches

c. Two inches or less of intermittent skipped stitches

d. Kinks or so-called "knotty thread" 2 inches or less from each other.

3.13.1.2 The stitching shall be removed and the item resewn if the following defects occur:

a. The number of stitches per inch is less than specified in table I

b. The stitching runs off: that is, extends beyond the edge of the seam or material

c. There are more than two consecutive skipped stitches

d. There are more than 2 inches of intermittent skipped stitches.

3.13.2 Darning deployment bag. Holes (see 6.5.3) not exceeding 1/4 inch in diameter may be darned. The darned area shall extend 3/8 inch beyond the hole on all sides and shall result in round or rectangular patterns. Linear tears or cuts up to 1/2 inch may be darned. The darned area shall form a rectangular pattern extending 1/4 inch beyond

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each side and each end of the tear. All darns shall be neat and flat and shall not pucker the cloth. Size A thread or yarns from the cloth shall be used for darning. The color of the darning thread or yarn shall match the color of the darned fabric. This paragraph shall be applicable to the deployment bag only because darning is not permitted on the canopy.

3.14 Measurements

3.14.1 Cloth. All cloth shall be measured and cut while under substantially no tension. Tightly rolled material shall be relaxed by unrolling for a period of at least 24 hours to permit material to return to its natural state. Patterns shall be carefully placed on the cloth to distribute the small inequities because of various cloth widths (within tolerances specified) on each side of the pattern. When multiple layers of cloth are being cut at the same time, extreme care shall be taken to prevent the cloth from slipping during any part of the cutting operation.

3.14.2 Radial, suspension, and vent lines. Radial, suspension, and vent lines shall be measured under the tensions specified in table III. Care shall be exercised in preparing proper line-measuring equipment. If equipment such as pulleys, guides, and reels are used, they shall not induce false loads on the material nor cause uneven load distribution on multiple-line measuring systems. Care shall be exercised to maintain uniformity in time control of load applications and control of large changes in temperature and humidity. Suspension lines of any one canopy measured under tension in accordance with table III and the applicable drawing shall not vary by more than 1 percent between the longest and the shortest lines.

TABLE III. Tensions for Measurements of Radial, Suspension, and Vent Lines

Tensile Strength (Pounds)	Tension (Pounds)
100 to 500	10 plus or minus 1/2
500 to 1,000	20 plus or minus 1
1,000 to 4,000	40 plus or minus 2
4,000 and up	1% plus or minus 4 of rated tensile strength

3.14.3 Webbings. All webbings, tapes, and ribbons used in assembling the drag surface shall be measured under no tension. The webbings shall not be measured while in the stretched state which is caused by winding the webbing onto the spool while the webbing is under tension. A uniform period of time of at least 24 hours between relaxing from a stretched state and marking shall be maintained.

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3.14.4 Drag surface. When finished dimensions are specified, proper allowances shall be made for stitching takeup to obtain the finished dimensions within the specified tolerances under any condition of humidity. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable drawing, all measurements of finished dimensions shall be made on the finished drag surface under nominal tension (see 6.5.4) within 15 seconds after application of the nominal tension.

3.14.5 Stitches. The number and spacing of stitching shall be measured under a tension of not less than 1/2 pound nor more than 1 pound.

3.15 Dimensions. Unless otherwise specified, the general tolerances on dimensions shall be in accordance with table IV.

TABLE IV. Tolerances on Dimensions

Dimensions (Inches)	Tolerances (Inch)
Under 2 1/	plus or minus 1/16
2 to 10	plus or minus 1/8
10 to 30	plus or minus 1/4
30 to 60	plus or minus 3/8
60 and up	plus or minus 1%

1/ Where a dimension of 1/16 inch is given, the tolerance shall be plus or minus 1/32 inch.

3.16 Additional requirements. The requirements of applicable drawings shall apply as requirements of this specification.

3.17 Finish

3.17.1 Ends. The ends of all material not covered by other cloth, tapes, webbings, or ribbons in the final assembly shall be treated to prevent fraying. The exposed ends of webbings, tapes, and ribbons shall be cut and turned under, seared (see 3.17.2) smoothly and evenly, or dipped in a hot mixture of 50 percent beeswax and 50 percent paraffin. Other solutions to prevent fraying may be used if samples are submitted and written approval obtained from the procuring activity (see 6.3). The ends of suspension lines shall be neatly trimmed back to the stitching, leaving an end that is not longer than 1/4 inch.

3.17.2 Searing. Searing shall not be permitted after stitching. Any searing permitted shall not leave sharp edges or points that may cause snagging of cloth material. Searing shall not be used where the end of the material is sandwiched between two other pieces of material or where the stitching runs continuously over the exposed ends. All searing shall be done neatly and shall not have any sharp edges or excess melted

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materials that might cause localized stresses. Whenever searing is used, the finished component part shall be carefully examined for holes and snags caused by poorly seared materials. One broken warp thread will be allowed in a tape or webbing provided that the strength of the material is not below the specified strength.

3.17.3 Cleanliness. All finished components without regard to complexity of design or manufacture shall be free of blemishes and foreign matter such as dirt, paint, oil, grease, graphite, stains, and any other discoloration.

3.18 Marking. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable drawing, equipment, assemblies, and parts shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-130. Fluid used for marking all textile parts shall conform to MIL-I-6903. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable drawing, the color of all markings on textile parts and all natural-color textile materials shall be color No. 13538 of FED-STD-595.

3.18.1 Assembly and stitching patterns. Using such marking mediums as fluids, chalk, and pencil to mark the canopy, deployment bag, and any other component parts to aid in assembly and to indicate stitching patterns shall be accomplished in a manner that will not adversely affect the utility, strength, or appearance of the parachute. Drilling and notching shall be kept to a minimum and the use thereof shall be restricted to the same limitations as marking. A hot needle shall not be used for marking or assembly if discoloring of the natural-color textile materials takes place.

3.19 Workmanship. The parachute system, including all parts and assemblies, shall be fabricated and finished in a workmanlike manner. Particular attention shall be given to cleanliness, accuracy of dimensions and markings, neatness and thoroughness of stitching, and proper assembly of component parts. The hardware components of the parachute shall be free from burrs and sharp edges.

3.19.1 Quality of canopy. The quality of the ribbon and guide surface canopies shall be exceptional in all respects. Dimensions specified for overall diameter shall be closely controlled and maintained because of the nature of the requirements. Proper fullness is mandatory for balanced load distribution of the vent, skirt, and horizontal and vertical ribbons.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Classification of tests. The inspection and testing of parachute systems shall be classified as follows:

a. Qualification testing

b. Quality conformance tests.

4.3 Qualification testing

4.3.1 Test samples. The qualification test sample shall consist of one untested complete parachute system or of any component thereof upon which qualification is desired and shall conform to all provisions of this specification and applicable drawings.

4.3.1.1 Date of manufacture. Qualification test samples of parachute systems shall be accompanied by a certificate to the effect that such samples were manufactured by the submitter during the preceding 90 days.

4.3.2 Qualification tests. The qualification tests shall consist of all tests described under 4.5 of this specification.

4.4 Quality conformance tests. Quality conformance tests shall consist of the following:

a. Individual tests

b. Sampling tests.

4.4.1 Individual tests. Each parachute component part shall be subjected to the examination of product described in 4.5.1.

4.4.2 Sampling tests. Samples of parachute systems from each production contract shall be selected at random, by the procuring activity (see 6.6), in accordance with table V. Selections will be made from contract scheduled deliveries. At the discretion of the procuring activity, these samples will be subjected to any and all of the following tests as described under 4.5 of this specification:

a. Examination of product

b. Drop tests.

4.4.2.1 Rejection and retest. When one or more items from a lot fail to meet the specification, acceptance of all items in the lot shall be withheld until the extent and cause of failure have been determined. The contractor shall explain fully to the Government representative the cause of failure and the action taken to preclude recurrence. After correction, all of the sampling tests shall be repeated.

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TABLE V. Number of Samples to be Tested

No. of Items on Contract	No. of Samples to be Submitted for Testing
Less than 500	2
500 to 1,000	3
1,001 to 2,000	4
2,001 to 5,000	5

4.4.2.2 Individual tests may continue. For production reasons, individual tests or other sampling plans may be continued pending the investigation of a sampling test failure. But final acceptance of the entire lot or lots produced later shall not be made until it is determined that the items meet all the requirements of the specification.

4.4.3 Defects in items already accepted. The investigation of a test failure could indicate that defects may exist in items already accepted. If so, the contractor shall fully advise the procuring activity of all the defects likely to be found and the method of correcting them.

4.5 Test methods

4.5.1 Examination of product. The parachute component parts shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified herein with respect to materials, dimensions, workmanship, cleanliness, and marking. Materials shall be verified in accordance with Bulletin 530. The defects found during inspection shall be classified in accordance with MIL-STD-849.

4.5.1.1 Seam examination. The guide surface canopy seams shall be examined for conformance to the applicable drawing by projection of a strong light through the seams. This inspection shall be accomplished prior to installation of suspension lines.

4.5.2 Drop tests. All drop tests shall be conducted on complete parachute assemblies and component parts when specified by the procuring activity and in accordance with the instructions of the procuring activity. The conditions for drop testing shall be in accordance with the operational requirements or the military characteristics of the specific system.

4.6 Inspection of preservation, packaging, and packing. Inspection of preservation, packaging, and packing shall be in accordance with the requirements of section 5 or the documents referenced therein.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, preservation, and packing. Unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity (see 6.2), the preservation, packaging, and packing of parachute systems shall be in accordance with MIL-P-5610.

5.2 Marking. Interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The heavy-duty parachute system covered by this specification is intended for use with special weapons at release conditions of high speed and low or high altitudes.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification

b. Requirements for drop tests (see 4.5.2)

c. Preservation, packaging, and packing required (see 5.1)

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are at the time set for opening of bids, qualified for inclusion in the applicable Qualified Products List whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of suppliers is called to this requirement, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. The activity responsible for the Qualified Products List is the Aeronautical Systems Division, Attention ASNMH-20, Wright-Patterson Air Force Base, Ohio 45433, and information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from that activity.

6.3.1 Samples specified in 4.3.1 should be forwarded to:

Wright-Patterson AFB, Ohio 45433
Marked for: ASD, Bldg 156, Area B
ATTN: ASNMH-20

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The following information should accompany the samples:

Samples for qualification testing
Nomenclature - Parachute System, Special Weapons, A/B28K-5, 23 Ft
Part No. 68C212-1
Name of Manufacturer
Submitted by (Name and date) for testing in accordance with the requirements of MIL-P-83255 (USAF).

6.4 Discrepancies. It will always be the supplier's responsibility to report in writing, immediately, any discrepancies between this specification and detailed specifications or applicable drawings.

6.5 Definitions

6.5.1 Zigzag stitches. A single-throw zigzag stitch is defined as having two needle drops, and a double-throw zigzag stitch is defined as having three needle drops.

6.5.2 Repair. A repair is a replacement of missing, broken, or removed thread or yarn.

6.5.3 Hole. A hole in the material is two or more broken yarns in the direction of either the warp or the fill, or both, of the material.

6.5.4 Nominal tension. Nominal tension is a pull of 1 percent of the specified strength of the material not to exceed 40 pounds.

6.6 Selection of samples. The selection of samples of parachute systems as specified in 4.4.2 will be made by SAAMA, Kelly Air Force Base, Texas.

Custodian:
Air Force - 11

Review activities:
Air Force - 79, 82

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 11

Project No. 1670-F358

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE | CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)* | DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 66 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

AFLC-WPAFB-OCT 67 2M

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